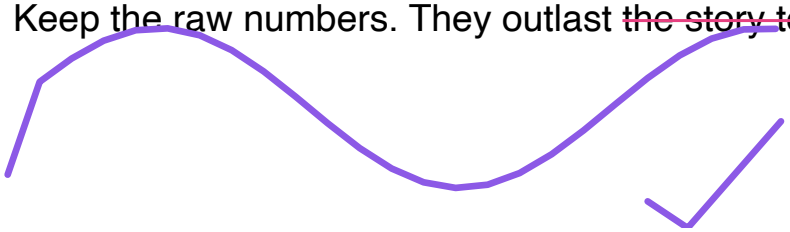
Notes on careful measurement

Every instrument tells you something about the world and something about itself. The trick is learning which is which before you write anything down. A careful measurement is repeated, and its spread is reported with its value.

Keep the raw numbers. They outlast the story told about them.



Waves and patterns

A wave carries a pattern without carrying the stuff it moves through. Watch a cork on a pond: it bobs, and stays.

A typed remark in the margin